

Small Business Cybersecurity Readiness Checklist

A practical review of identity, devices, email, backups, network security and employee access.

PURPOSE

Find the gaps before they become business problems

Use this checklist to quickly identify whether a business has the basic controls needed to reduce common cyber risk. A "no" answer does not always mean a system is failing, but it does indicate an area that should be reviewed before it becomes a business problem.

HOW TO USE IT

Ten checks, one honest answer each

- 1 Answer with whoever manages your IT, accounts and devices.
- 2 Mark **Yes**, **No** or **Unknown** for each check.
- 3 Write the owner, and any evidence, on the notes line.
- 4 Count your No and Unknown answers and read the guide on the last page.

WHAT'S COVERED

Three areas, ten checks

- | | |
|-------|--|
| 01–04 | Identity and devices. MFA, stale and shared accounts, device inventory, encryption and endpoint security. |
| 05–07 | Email, backups and network. Phishing and impersonation filtering, restore testing, secure remote access. |
| 08–10 | People and process. Onboarding and offboarding, security awareness training, leadership reporting. |

01 Security readiness review

Identity and devices

4 CHECKS

C01 IDENTITY
Are all users protected by MFA, especially administrators? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C02 IDENTITY
Are stale accounts, former employees and shared logins removed or controlled? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C03 DEVICES
Does the business have an accurate device inventory? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C04 DEVICES
Are laptops and desktops encrypted and protected by endpoint security? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

Email, backups and network

3 CHECKS

C05 EMAIL
Are phishing, impersonation and malicious attachments filtered? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C06 BACKUPS
Have backups been restored and tested recently? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C07 NETWORK
Is remote access secured without exposing unnecessary services? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

People and process

3 CHECKS

C08 **POLICIES**
Is onboarding and offboarding documented and repeatable? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C09 **TRAINING**
Do employees receive security awareness training? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

C10 **REPORTING**
Does leadership receive recurring security and technology reporting? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Unknown

NOTES / OWNER

02 Reading your answers

Count the checks you marked **No** or **Unknown**. This is a rule of thumb for deciding what to do next, not an assessment or a score of your security.

NO + UNKNOWN

WHAT IT SUGGESTS

0-2 Basic posture may be acceptable, but should still be validated.

3-5 Schedule a focused security review.

6 or more Treat it as a priority risk review before a preventable issue becomes expensive.

NOTES AND FOLLOW-UPS

NEXT STEP**Request a Cyber Risk Assessment**

If several items are unknown or marked no, a Cyber Risk Assessment shows what is exposed and whether you need a targeted standalone service or broader managed IT and security ownership through the ProActive Ecosystem.

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Educational checklist. It does not assess or certify any environment. This document names no customers and makes no vendor-specific claims.